becoming and suffering (***samsara***). The active religion of the householder generating wealth, producing children and co-operating in the maintenance of social and cosmic order is inevitably involved in the sort of purposive action that binds one to ***samsara*** by generating ***karma***. One of the questions that the *Gita* confronts is how one may continue to live in the world, obeying one's social and ritual duties, without generating ***karma***. It rejects the path of radical renunciation and knowledge (***samnyasa***), teaching that, since action is unavoidable for embodied beings, one should renounce desire for the fruits of action, not actions themselves. Disinterested and disciplined action, action without a desire for its fruits, will not generate ***karma***. This is called *karma-yoga*. The *Gita* is a monotheistic text and *Krishna* portrays himself as a creator god who has also ordained the social order. Since he is the source of all, the appropriate response is the dedication of actions and their results to him in a spirit of worship (*bhakti*). Moreover, God is the ultimate agent and humans merely instruments of what are in fact his actions. Realising that one is not really an agent and then performing all one's actions in service to God prompts saving divine grace (*prasada*) leading to liberation.

Further reading: Buitenen 1953; Johnson 1994; Lipner 1997; Matilal 2002a; Zaehner 1969

Bhakti-marga (path of devotion): a path to release from the series of rebirths whose critical component is devotion to God. Devotion may be a matter of passionate feeling but it may also be an attitude of mind – a lucid understanding of the natures of God and the soul in the light of which a person performs their social and religious obligations. This involves remembering that it is not just the person who acts but that God acts in them as the inner guide (*antaryamin*). Thus one acts not out of desire for the fruits